



YOU ARE **25 WEEKS AND 3 DAYS**

102 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The hands are held up in front of the face. In the top right-hand corner is the inner lining of the uterus. Shadows in the image give the impression of hair, but ultrasound is not detailed enough to show hair—even if there was any to see at this stage.

“Going to prenatal classes together is a good way for your partner to stay closely involved with your pregnancy.”

Not all partners are eager to go to prenatal classes. They might not feel the classes apply to them, and may fear that they will be asked to do exercises that they find embarrassing.

If your partner is reluctant, discuss their concerns. You can review what the classes are for and why you need their support. You could explain that you want them to be informed about labor so that they are not anxious in the delivery room. Your partner may find it useful to chat to other friends who attended classes when they were having a baby.

Classes may include some sessions just for partners and others where the pregnant women attend on their own, for example, to practice breathing techniques. If time off work is an issue for your partner, ask for a list of what topics will be covered each week and pick those sessions that you think are the most relevant. When your partner is well informed, they will feel more involved in the pregnancy and more confident in helping you during labor and birth.

RELATIONSHIP CHANGES

Once your baby is born, your relationship won't just be about you and your partner any more. Suddenly a tiny new person is around, who wakes during the night and has their own needs. By necessity, after your baby is born you and your partner will pay less attention to each other. There may also be less physical intimacy between the two of you, not least because you both will be very tired.

It's best to talk about, and acknowledge, these issues before the birth. This way, you and your partner will better accept that these factors are a normal part of making the life change from coupledness to being a family.